

▽ Illustration of Guarani Indian life by Jesuit missionary Florian Baucke



1750

TREATY OF MADRID

Signed on 14 January 1750, the Treaty of Madrid attempted to settle the colonial boundary between Spain and Portugal in the New World, superseding the earlier Treaty of Tordesillas (1524). In the hope of containing Portuguese expansion, Spain ceded much of what is now Brazil to Portugal. The treaty faced intense resistance from both Jesuit missionaries in South America and the native Guarani peoples; the boundary was finally agreed in the First Treaty of San Ildefonso (1777).

1750

1750 Hannah Snell is honourably discharged from the British armed forces after serving for several years disguised as a man

1751 British East India Company forces take Arcot in the Second Carnatic War against the French

1752 Burma unites under Alaungpaya; his Konbaung dynasty rules until 1885

1751

BRITISH GIN CRAZE

The consumption of gin increased rapidly in Great Britain in the early 18th century. Cheap and easily available, gin fuelled a social crisis, satirized by artist William Hogarth in his prints comparing the evils of gin consumption with the merits of beer drinking. After several unsuccessful attempts to curb consumption, the 1751 Gin Act limited gin sales, and the gin craze petered out.

“Gin, cursed fiend, with
fury fraught, makes
human race a prey.”

VERSE WRITTEN FOR HOGARTH'S GIN LANE BY
JAMES TOWNLEY, 1751



△ *Gin Lane*, William Hogarth's satire of the gin crisis